

CO5-ASSESSMENT TOOL 3

ITA1407 - Ethical Hacking

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1. How would you evaluate the security posture of a Windows system after identifying multiple open services?

Answer: I would check which ports and services are open, whether they are necessary, and whether they are properly patched and configured. Unnecessary or vulnerable services increase the attack surface and can make the Windows system less secure.

2. Why are rhosts and hosts.equiv considered security risks in Linux? How would you evaluate their impact on system security?

Answer: They are risky because they use trust-based authentication and may allow access without normal password verification. I would check which users and hosts are trusted and determine whether this trust could allow unauthorized access.

3. How would you evaluate whether a buffer overflow vulnerability in a Linux application is practically exploitable?

Answer: I would check whether the vulnerable input can actually trigger the buffer overflow and what conditions are required. I would also consider protections such as ASLR and stack canaries and then evaluate the possible security impact.

4. How would you evaluate the security of a mobile application using a tool such as MobSF?

Answer: I would use MobSF to check permissions, insecure data storage, hardcoded secrets, network security, and other application weaknesses. I would then verify important findings and assess their security impact.

5. You have identified vulnerabilities in Windows, Linux, messaging, web, and mobile applications. How would you prioritize them and prepare a professional security report?

Answer: I would prioritize vulnerabilities based on exploitability, impact, exposure, and the number of users or systems affected. Critical vulnerabilities that are easy to exploit and can cause major damage should be fixed first, and the report should include evidence, severity, impact, and recommended fixes.